



Apple Music for Android

Apple Music on Android is getting some much needed features in dark mode and Chromecast support. <https://digit.in/oct19-15>



Snapchat Snap Originals

Snapchat has announced eight new premium Snap Originals, which are made-for-mobile, in portrait orientation. <https://digit.in/oct19-16>



PHOTOGRAMMETRIST

A map-maker on steroids, a Photogrammetrist dabbles in the archaic task of creating maps by using a combination of technology and software

Dhriti Datta | dhriti@digit.in

N

ot many people have heard of the term 'photogrammetry', or they have, but they don't really under-

stand what exactly this discipline of geography entails. Cartography, on the other hand, is a well-known profession of creating geographical maps. Both cartography and photogrammetry have professionals working in the same field – geography, however, their approaches to achieving their end goals, and sometimes, their ends goals itself, are entirely different. We're going to delve into the lesser-known field of photogrammetry and everything you need to keep in mind if you're considering a career in this esoteric field.

WHAT IS PHOTOGRAMMETRY?

Photogrammetry is the process by which metric information about an

object or the Earth's surface is derived through measurements such as shape, volume and depth, made from a photograph of the same surface or object. The method uses the parallax obtained from several images, of an object or terrain, taken from different angles. This allows photogrammetrists to get reliable information about the environment or physical objects through several processes such as recording, measuring, and interpreting photographs.

This process is actually as old as photography itself since it was first developed around 150 years ago. At the



All photographs have 3D potential with photogrammetry

time of its inception, photogrammetry was a purely analogue technique, however, over the years, it has transcended to become an analytical process based on computer-aided mathematical algorithms. At its current stage, photogrammetry is purely digital and based on soft-copies of photographs where digital imagery and computer vision is used to map the Earth's surface or other physical objects with no optomechanical hardware.

The images can be satellite imagery, aerial photographs or even regular handheld or tripod-taken photographs. It has multiple applications such as the measuring of coordinates, quantification of distances, creation of topographic maps, digital elevation models, and even orthophotographs.

**SIMPLY PUT,
PHOTOGRAMMETRY IS
THE PRACTICE OF MAKING
PRECISE MEASUREMENTS
OF 3D OBJECTS FROM
2D PHOTOGRAPHS AND
CONVERTING THEM INTO
MAPS OR 3D MODELS.**

WHAT DOES A PHOTOGRAMMETRIST DO?

A photogrammetrist specialises in the practice of utilising satellite images, aerial photographs, GPS, an array of software catered to this field, and even LiDAR (Light Detection and Ranging) to create 3D models of the Earth's surface or a variety of other objects such as stones, buildings, interiors and more. They work on compiling and analysing spatial data such as distance and elevation to create maps and models. They collect all this information in order to create or update maps for regional planning, education and other purposes. Their target is designing user-friendly maps which can be accessed and understood by the masses easily and can also have GIS (geo-